

22 July 2026

Editor

Marine Environmental Research

Re: Full-length Article submission, "Spatiotemporal associations between coastal birds and Pacific herring spawning in British Columbia"

Dear Editor,

Please consider this manuscript as a Full-length Article in *Marine Environmental Research*. Pacific herring spawning creates a brief coastal resource pulse, and the study links effort-aware complete eBird checklists to event-level Fisheries and Oceans Canada spawn information to estimate checklist detection and positive numeric-count associations with recorded local exposure.

The registered Stage 4A core provides confirmatory observational evidence. The analysis preserves concurrent event links without duplicating checklists and keeps detection, numeric counts, and unquantified X records distinct. Historical partial pooling was repaired using compatible family identities while preserving every individual estimate, confidence interval, p-value, and model-specific Benjamini-Hochberg q-value. The complete submission reports matched whole-bundle placebos, WCVI spatial and observer sensitivities, blocked validation, and all singular-fit warnings.

The manuscript prominently reports a non-null prespecified Strait of Georgia specificity panel. That result constrains causal and simple ecological-specificity interpretations without erasing the checklist-conditional associations or directly testing conditional positive-count responses. The paper therefore presents both the substantive ecological pattern and the observation-process alternatives needed for a balanced interpretation.

The manuscript fits the journal's interest in biological interactions and quantitative monitoring of coastal systems. Relevant reviewer expertise includes coastal-bird and forage-fish ecology, community-science inference, mixed-effects models, spatial exposure linkage, falsification methods, and reproducible ecological analysis.

[AUTHOR TO CONFIRM BEFORE SUBMISSION: This work has not been published previously except as any disclosed preprint, is not under consideration elsewhere, and its submission and publication are approved by the author and responsible institution.]

[AUTHOR TO CONFIRM BEFORE SUBMISSION: Identify any preprint or closely related submitted/published work, or state "None."]

Privacy-safe aggregate data, code, specifications, and provenance are available at <https://github.com/JTDingwall/herring-x-ebird-version-2>. Restricted eBird records and protected row-level derivatives cannot be redistributed; the manuscript explains the source-access route and reconstruction requirements. No production response model or

protected sensitivity was rerun for manuscript preparation, no statistical estimate changed, and no frozen analysis artifact was altered.

Thank you for considering the manuscript.

Sincerely,

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[AUTHOR TO SUPPLY: full postal address and telephone number]